THE ED MASTERS

BYJU RAVEENDRAN, 40
DIVYA GOKULNATH, 35

Co-founders, Byju's
Bengaluru

THE NEXT 100 ENTREPRENEURS

"I hadn't envisioned a specific career path, but I knew I would give 100 per cent to whatever I did"
DIVYA GOKULNATH

Understated, ambitious and an astute educator—Byju Raveendran calls himself an accidental entrepreneur. A journey that began with helping friends ace the CAT (Common Admission Test) and holding classes for whoever was interested led him to co-founding Byju's with his former student and then wife, Divya Gokulnath. Today, Byju's is the world's most valuable edtech startup, at $21 billion (Rs 1.6 lakh crore) as of August this year. Before co-founding the firm, Gokulnath was a teacher. Her love for teaching and her ability to keep her people together has ensured that Byju's core team has remained intact since it was founded. During the pandemic, the firm launched a slew of online classes for students across age groups. It also made several acquisitions—about eight this year—extending its footprint to the US. In terms of numbers, the Byju's app has been downloaded over 100 million times, and classes are available in 1,700 cities worldwide. According to the firm, it added 13.5 million students in March and April 2020. ■

–Shwweta Punj



COUPLE OF GOALS Gokulnath's love for biology comes from her father, but her appreciation for maths comes from her husband. Raveendran worked at a shipping company before returning to India to start Byju's